Push 2 / Nuendo Bridge

Windows Installation Guide — Version 1.0.6

Standalone .exe — no Python, no pip, no command line

From version 1.0.4 the Windows bridge is a single self-contained executable. The Python interpreter, every dependency and the libusb USB runtime are bundled inside the .exe. You only need to set up the virtual MIDI ports (loopMIDI) and the Nuendo/Cubase MIDI Remote script — the Push 2's USB driver installs itself automatically on Windows.

> *On Windows the bridge runs from the **system tray** (look for its icon near the clock) rather than a console window. Right-click the tray icon for status, Open Plugin Mapper, Show Log, and Quit. To run the classic console version instead, launch the .exe with the `--terminal` flag.*

What you downloaded

- **Push2NuendoBridge-vX.Y.Z-Windows.zip** — unzip it anywhere you like (e.g. `Documents\Push2Bridge`). It contains:
- `Push2 Nuendo Bridge_vX.Y.Z.exe` — the bridge (double-click to run).
- `Ableton_Push2.js` — the Nuendo / Cubase MIDI Remote script.
- PDF guides (User Guide, Release Notes, Plugin Mapper Guide).

  Do not delete the .exe after “installing” — it is the application; run it from wherever you keep the unzipped folder.

Step 1 — loopMIDI virtual ports

- Download and install loopMIDI: https://www.tobias-erichsen.de/software/loopmidi.html
- Open loopMIDI and create **four** ports with these EXACT names (type the name, click the **+** button):

```
NuendoBridge In
NuendoBridge Out
BridgeNotes
BridgeNotes In
```

- Right-click the loopMIDI tray icon and enable **“Autostart loopMIDI”** so the ports exist every time Windows starts.

Step 2 — Push 2 USB driver (automatic)

- **There is nothing to install.** The Push 2 advertises a Microsoft “WinUSB” compatible-ID descriptor, so Windows 8/10/11 installs the right driver automatically the first time you plug it in. The bridge talks to the Push 2 through that built-in WinUSB driver.
- Just connect the Push 2 by USB and wait a few seconds for Windows to finish setting it up. No Zadig, no manual driver step.

  The bridge and Ableton Live use this same WinUSB driver, but only one app can hold the Push 2's USB connection at a time — so the bridge and Live cannot control the Push simultaneously. Close one to use the other. No driver change is needed to go back and forth (tested with Live 12). macOS is not affected.

Fallback (rare): if the bridge cannot find the Push 2 even though it is connected, see “Push 2 not detected” in Troubleshooting below.

Step 3 — Install the MIDI Remote script

- Copy **Ableton_Push2.js** into the Steinberg MIDI Remote scripts folder, creating the sub-folders if they do not exist:

```
Nuendo:
C:\Users\<user>\Documents\Steinberg\Nuendo\MIDI Remote\Driver
Scripts\Local\Ableton\Push2\
```

```
Cubase:
C:\Users\<user>\Documents\Steinberg\Cubase\MIDI Remote\Driver
Scripts\Local\Ableton\Push2\
```

Replace <user> with your Windows user name. The `Local\Ableton\Push2` sub-folders usually do not exist yet — create them.

Step 4 — Run the bridge

- Connect the Push 2 by USB (and make sure Ableton Live is closed).
- **Double-click the .exe.** The bridge starts in the **Windows system tray** (look for its icon near the clock, bottom-right). No console window opens.
- **Right-click the tray icon** for the menu: connection status, **Open Plugin Mapper** (http://localhost:8100), **Show Log** (opens the log file), and **Quit**.
- The bridge does **not** open a browser automatically. Use the tray menu's Open Plugin Mapper when you need it.
- To **quit**, right-click the tray icon and choose Quit.

  Prefer a console? Launch the .exe with the `--terminal` *flag (e.g. from a Command Prompt, or a shortcut with --terminal appended) to get the classic console version with live status text.*

  Windows SmartScreen may warn on first launch because the .exe is not code-signed. Click “More info → Run anyway”. The CI-built release is reproducible from the public source.

Step 5 — Nuendo / Cubase configuration

Automatic setup: Nuendo usually detects the script and assigns its ports on its own when you open a project.

If the script does not load automatically

- Open any project.
- Studio → MIDI Remote Manager → **Add MIDI Controller Surface**.
- Vendor = **Ableton**, Model = **Push2**.
- MIDI Input = **NuendoBridge Out**, MIDI Output = **NuendoBridge In**.

Note Input

Set the instrument track's MIDI input to **BridgeNotes** (enable it in Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup if hidden).

Important — avoid doubled notes

- In Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup, **uncheck “In ‘All MIDI Inputs’” for both Push 2 ports** — “Ableton Push 2” (Live Port) and “Ableton Push 2 User Port”. Otherwise every pad is received twice.

Plugin Mapper (optional)

- The Plugin Mapper web server is bundled and starts automatically with the .exe — no extra install. Open it from the tray menu (**Open Plugin Mapper**) or browse to `http://localhost:8100` to create custom plugin parameter mappings. See the Plugin Mapper Guide for details.

Troubleshooting

- **Push 2 not detected / “Could not connect to Push 2”** — Close Ableton Live (only one app can hold the Push at a time). Unplug and replug the USB cable so Windows finishes installing the driver; give it a few seconds. **Last resort** (very rare, e.g. an old Windows build or a corporate-locked PC that does not auto-install the driver): install WinUSB manually with **Zadig** (https://zadig.akeo.ie) — Options → List All Devices → select **Ableton Push 2** (display/bulk interface, USB ID `2982:1967`, **not** the MIDI interface) → WinUSB → Install Driver.
- **“Could not open MIDI ports”** — loopMIDI is not running or the four port names are not exactly as in Step 1.
- **Push 2 connects but Nuendo does nothing** — The MIDI Remote script is missing or the surface ports are wrong (Step 3 / Step 5).
- **Doubled pad notes** — Uncheck the two Push 2 ports from “In All MIDI Inputs” (Step 5).
- **SmartScreen / antivirus blocks the .exe** — Allow it; PyInstaller one-file executables are a common false positive.

Support

- Website: https://push2bridge.kaikuaudio.com
- Issues: https://github.com/mbourque-mix/Push2Nuendo-Bridge/issues